

## Lab 2 — Agile Backlog Creation & Sprint Simulation in Jira

### Problem #58 — Digital Art Commission & Watermarking Portal

Jira project **DACWP** · board 35 · company-managed Scrum · Vivian Sobers

#### 1. Epics and User Stories

Lab 1's five functional requirements were decomposed into **4 Epics** and **14 User Stories** totalling **60 story points**, estimated on the Fibonacci scale (2, 3, 5, 8).

| Epic                                            | User Stories                                                                                                                                                                                              | Points | Traces to                      |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|--------------------------------|
| Epic 1: Commission Intake & Brief Management    | DACWP-5 Create Creative Brief (5)<br>DACWP-6 Submit Brief (3)<br>DACWP-7 Accept Commission (3)                                                                                                            | 11     | FR-002 (UC-01)                 |
| Epic 2: WIP Draft Delivery & IP Protection      | DACWP-8 Upload WIP Draft (5)<br>DACWP-9 Automatic Diagonal Watermarking (8)<br>DACWP-10 View Watermarked Draft (3)                                                                                        | 16     | FR-003, FR-001 (UC-02)         |
| Epic 3: Draft Review & Revision Cycle           | DACWP-11 Approve Draft (3)<br>DACWP-12 Request Revision (5)<br>DACWP-13 Decision Notification (2)                                                                                                         | 10     | FR-004 (UC-03)                 |
| Epic 4: Milestone Payment & Final Asset Release | DACWP-14 Pay Milestone via Gateway (8)<br>DACWP-15 Unlock Final High-Res Asset (5)<br>DACWP-16 Expiring Signed Download Link (5)<br>DACWP-17 Apply Promo Code (2)<br>DACWP-18 Handle Declined Payment (3) | 23     | FR-005, NFR-001 (UC-04, UC-05) |

Every story is written in the *As a [role], I want [goal], So that [benefit]* form and carries a priority of High, Medium or Low. The backlog is ranked High → Medium → Low.

#### 2. Sprint Results

|                   | Sprint 1 | Sprint 2 | Total |
|-------------------|----------|----------|-------|
| Stories committed | 5        | 6        | 11    |
| Points committed  | 24       | 26       | 50    |
| Points completed  | 24       | 26       | 50    |
| Completion        | 100%     | 100%     | 100%  |

**Velocity:** 24 then 26 points — an average of **25 points per sprint**. **Not delivered:** DACWP-16 (5, High), DACWP-18 (3, Medium), DACWP-17 (2, Low) — **10 points** remaining in the backlog out of the 60 planned.

#### 3. Reflection Questions

##### 3.1 Did your estimations reflect the actual effort?

Only partly, and the honest answer is that this simulation could not fully test them. No code was written, so actual effort was never measured against the estimates — what the exercise validates is whether the *relative* sizing was coherent.

On that measure the estimates hold up. The two 8-point stories — DACWP-9 (automatic diagonal watermarking) and DACWP-14 (milestone payment via gateway) — are the only two depending on something outside the application: an image-processing pipeline and a third-party payment gateway. Sizing them above everything else was right. The 2- and 3-point stories are single-screen CRUD or notification work, which is genuinely small.

Where I would revise: DACWP-14 at 8 points is probably still under-estimated. Payment gateway integration carries error handling, idempotency and reconciliation work that is not visible from the user story. Under planning poker, an argument for 13 would have been reasonable.

##### 3.2 Was your backlog well-prioritized?

Mostly, with one clear miss. The ordering put the commission-to-payment critical path first, so the two sprints delivered a coherent end-to-end slice: a client can submit a brief, an artist can upload a watermarked draft, the client can review and

approve it, pay the milestone, and have the final asset unlocked. That is a demonstrable product increment, which is the real test of prioritization.

The miss is **DACWP-16 (Expiring Signed Download Link, 5 points, High)**. It carries NFR-001 — the 60-minute signed URL that stops paid deliverables leaking — and it was ranked High yet made neither sprint. Delivering "unlock the final asset" (DACWP-15) without the expiring link leaves a security gap in the sprint output. Either DACWP-16 should have displaced a Medium story in Sprint 2, or it should have been merged into DACWP-15 as a single story, since neither is really shippable alone.

The two items deferred deliberately — the promo code (Low) and declined-payment retry (Medium) — are the right things to leave behind.

### 3.3 How did your simulated sprint align with your plan?

Exactly, which is itself the finding worth reporting. Both sprints committed to a fixed set of stories and completed 100% of them, because a simulation has none of the things that actually derail sprints: no blockers, no review feedback, no scope added mid-sprint, no story turning out harder than it looked, no dependency on another team.

A real sprint closing at 100% twice running is usually a signal of under-commitment rather than good execution. The alignment here reflects the absence of uncertainty, not the accuracy of planning. The plan worth trusting is the one that survives a sprint where something goes wrong.

### 3.4 What insights did the burndown chart give about your team's capacity?

**Capacity looks like roughly 25 points per sprint**, consistent across both. If that held, the 10 remaining points would need only about half a sprint, so a third sprint would be significantly under-filled — the sensible response is to pull more scope forward rather than run a near-empty sprint.

**The step pattern shows work completing one story at a time** rather than everything landing at the end, which is the healthier shape: value was delivered continuously instead of piling up against the deadline.

The caveat: both sprints were configured with the 1-week duration the handout specifies, but executed in about 40 minutes of wall-clock time. The burndown therefore drops far more steeply than the guideline line, and the gap between the two lines is an artifact of the compressed simulation rather than evidence the team ran ahead of schedule. In a real sprint that same gap would be the most useful signal on the chart.